

A D D I S O N



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Gourmands and style seekers alike will delight in Addison Restaurant, Fairmont Grand Del Mar resort's signature eatery. Named for Addison Mizner, the architect whose work inspired the style of the resort, this upscale restaurant has a sophisticated atmosphere with European-style furnishings and grand, arched windows overlooking the golf course. Chef William Bradley takes diners on a culinary adventure here, offering seasonal and ever-changing ten-course menus highlighting his contemporary cooking style. The impressive, exhaustive wine list carries everything from little-known finds to well-known favorites.

# A D D I S O N



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## TEPACHE - WELCOME DRINK

Fermented Pineapple, Piloncillo, Cinnamon, and Clove

## OYSTER

Kumamoto Oyster, Horseradish Panna Cotta, Smoked Ikura, Pickled Green Apple  
Borage Flowers and Star Anise Blossoms

## PRELUDE

Sake Cured Kanpachi « Nigiri » of Wasabi, Shiso Leaf, and Dashi Meringue  
Sage Hill Ranch Garden Greens with Olive Oil, On Top of a Puffed Cracker Filled with Mascarpone and Goat Cheese  
Potato Rösti with Spanish Anchovies, Wild Arugula Purée, and Meyer Lemon Jam  
Chicken Liver Feuilles de Brick « Churro », Bitter Chocolate, and Cinnamon

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## KANPACHI ROSE

Kanpachi Sashimi Swirled with Preserved Asian Pears and Sliced Pichuberries  
Delicately Arranged Shiso Blossoms, Golden Kiwi, Myoga, and Ginger Zest  
Pichuberry Ponzu and Ginger Oil

## CHAWANMUSHI

Addison's Signature Chawanmushi, with Hokkaido Uni and North-California Scallop  
Cubes of Bok Choy and Celtuce, Broccoli, Chive oil, Purple Pickled Daikon

## CAVIAR - "EGG & RICE"

Regiis Ova Reserve Caviar, Koshihikari Rice, Applewood-Smoked Sabayon, Arare Puffed Rice, and Toasted Sesame

## MALT VINEGAR CRISPS

Burnt Onion Creme Fraiche with Dill and Burnt Onion Powder, Dill Relish

## KINMEDAI

Kinmedai Matsukasa-yaki, Clam Butter Sauce Made with Clam and Oboro Kombu  
Chive Oil, Scallions, Fennel, Artichoke, Radish

## SOURDOUGH

Sourdough Made with Heirloom Grains Back in the 1700s  
Whipped Goat Milk, and Browned Butter with Honey

## TOM KHA GAI-GOONG

Thai Style Tom Kha Goong Soup Made with Swarnadwipa Curry Mix and Shrimp Stock  
Beech Mushroom, Finger lime, Norwegian King Crab, and Lime to Squeeze In  
Served with a Bowl of Fried Sweet and Sour Fowl

## SQUAB

Grilled Breast and Tenderloin, Six-Hour Confit Leg, Yakitori Style Heart  
A Quenelle of Peanut Butter Miso, Sauce of Sweet-Savory Shoyu  
Complimented by Pickled Cucumber, Purple Pickled Daikon,  
Cipollini Onion, and Soubise Onion Purée

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## PALATE CLEANSER

Yuzu and Mint Blancmange, Matcha, and Matcha Espuma

## SWEET TREATS

Berry-Beet Tartelette, Verjus, and Vanilla  
Caramelized Honey Bonbon, with White Chocolate, Rosemary, Ginger, and Toasted Macaroon Almonds  
Carrot Cake Cone Filled with Orange Marmalade, Topped with Nutmeg Cream Cheese Frosting, and Candied Orange  
Addison's Version of « Tres leches » in Taco Shaped Feuilles  
Chocolate Tuile, Layered Hazelnut Cacao Cake, Toasted Marshmallow, and Passionfruit Mezcal Caramel

## FAREWELL GIFT

Toffee with Sunflower Seed





The official definition of a three Michelin-star restaurant, as per the prestigious red guide, is as follows: "Exceptional cuisine, worth a special journey."

While I have had the pleasure of dining at numerous three Michelin-star restaurants across the globe, this marks my first journey to a city solely to experience a particular restaurant. Nestled within the out-of-nowhere Fairmont Grand del Mar resort, the Addison restaurant is, just like the resort, a culinary gem hard to come by that appears out of nowhere in the suburban of San Diego. It is not only the sole three Michelin-starred restaurant in the entire Southern California region, but also one of the fastest establishments to earn the prestigious three Michelin stars. In 2019, the Michelin Guide returned to the greater Los Angeles area after a nine-year break, awarding Addison its first Michelin star. This recognition thrust Addison, the only Michelin-starred restaurant in San Diego, into the spotlight of the culinary world. The restaurant's rise to prominence was further solidified when it received its second Michelin star in the subsequent 2021 guide (no guide was established in 2020), followed swiftly by its third star in 2022. To fully immerse in this highly anticipated degustation journey, we choose to arrive a day before, settling ourselves in the tranquil resort.



Following an exhausting itinerary of horseback riding at the equestrian center in the resort and some kayaking on the ocean of the La Jolla area, a grand feast at the Addison restaurant awaits. From the lobby to the entrance of the restaurant, the concierge team has arranged us with their luxurious BMW SUV courtesy car. Upon arrival, we are immediately greeted by the receptionists who ushers us into the spacious yet cozy resting area. Seating on the sofa by the fireplace, we are promptly presented with a heavy book of remarkably comprehensive wine list. Such a list I have only seen at Per Se, although it still falls far short of the encyclopedic presence of the wine list at Robuchon au Dome in Macau, it is already a miracle to be reckoned with. Despite the attentive hospitality, reading the wine list was challenging considering the dim ambiance. Without much delay, our servers guide us to a large round table in the center of the restaurant, spacious enough for four or five people. It allows us to overlook all the activity in the restaurant while providing a somewhat tranquil and restful view of the fabulous marble fireplace, ensuring a unique dining experience that is both immersive and isolated from the bustling environment.





With such an all-compassing wine list before us, it is just wrong not to order some bottles from it. I considered opting for the wine pairing, but past experiences have taught me that combining it with an already extensive tasting menu can be overwhelming, potentially diluting the full experience of each dish in detail. Addison also offers champagne trolley service, with two bottles of Krug and a bottle of Cristal that are both ridiculously overpriced. It is thus an unmissable treat for me when I find the 2007 Michel Niellon Chassagne-Montrachet 1er Cru “Les Champgains” and the 2005 Vincent Girardin Charmes-Chambertin, both at such reasonable prices. Both Michel Niellon and Vincent Girardin are domaines of exceptional quality but without too much attention from the outsiders world. The 2007 Les Champgains is simply a showstopper. It unwinds in the glass with a splendid, almost surreal aroma bomb of matured hazelnut, woody oak, and aged fermented honey. Hints of spiced pear and earthy minerals further saturate the lush aroma profile. The golden, almost brown hue already suggests its sophisticated aroma, but it is just mind-blowing when taking a sip. The 2005 Charmes Chambertin is rather classical. A very elegantly untamed Charmes Chambertin red indeed, revealing a dark fruit cored juice with accents of earthiness that is almost like a combination of truffle, licorice, and vetiver. The nose is somehow powdery that resembles pork floss — interestingly, the fine also showcases an umami that is somehow similar to pork floss, probably due to its oriental spice-ish characteristics.



Soon after we get seated, maybe too soon, presented two shots of welcoming drink comprising fermented pineapple accented by piloncillo, cinnamon, and clove, all classy for a tepache drink. Details of the drink unfortunately fail to linger in my memory as I was carefully picking wines from the list. The first bite, a small yet delicate composition of oyster, arrives again too soon. In the mini bowl in the shape of an oyster shell, we spot a Kumamoto oyster resting on top of a bed of horseradish panna cotta. The medley is further saturated by the amazing flavor melange of smoked ikura, pickled green apple, borage flowers, and star anise blossoms. The pungent sharpness of the horseradish is well-tamed by the panna cotta that reveals a silky, creamy, and rich texture to encapsulate the crispy oceanic umami of the oyster. The smoky tone from the ikura stands out, sublimating the whole with a unique dimension of sensation, while the pickled green apple underlines the whole with its refreshing, ponzu-like flavor as well as its crispy texture.









Without much time for me to absorb the last dish, a set of four amuse bouches arrives with tsunamis of information and flavors. Named prelude, the four amuse bouches line up before us, with the Kanpachi nigiri taking center stage and the salad cracker, potato rösti, and chicken liver churro on the side. The “prelude” title almost sounds bizarre to me as a prelude is a musical term referring to something that happens at the front, in this case, I am confused as there is something before the prelude, making that welcoming drink something a prelude to a prelude. Put that aside, the amuse bouches steel my heart with marvelous flavors injected in small pieces. The Kanpachi nigiri is probably one of the most famous creations of the restaurant. At the heart of the creation, we spot the sake-cured kanpachi tartare perching on a cloudy dashi Meringue and accented with wasabi and shiso leaf to emphasize its Japanese inspiration while lifting the whole with a mild herbal kick. Within one bite, one shall be amazed by the lightness of the meringue, which embraces the kanpachi so well that it almost feels like a perfectly amalgamated entirety.





The rest bites of the prelude are remarkable in their own way as well, albeit the fast tempo of the ongoing journey and the lifeless reciting-style explanation of the server make the process somehow flash by without much time of serious degustation. The Sage Hill Ranch garden greens atop a puffed cracker filled with mascarpone and goat cheese resemble a miniature salad in a single bite, akin to a meticulously crafted Japanese garden scene encapsulated within a bonsai. The goat cheese offers a rather rich dairy flavor that immediately distinguishes the bite from the previous meringue one. The Potato Rösti, a compact cube bursting with robust senses, delivers an intense and pesante flavor bomb to the palate, pushing the boundaries of bearable flavor richness to the brink. Topped with Spanish anchovies, the small cube fully showcases the potential of frying and preserving methods to condense flavor to its utmost within extremely limited space. Though it challenges the taste limits of some, it is undoubtedly memorable. The wild arugula purée and Meyer lemon jam may seem insignificant here, but on a micro level, they indeed enrich the palate and balance the whole efficiently.

The unique taste of arugula— bright, tart, peppery, and slightly bitter— sets it apart from other greens, almost like a spice, adding depth to this bite-sized delight. The final bite, a chicken liver Feuilles de Brick, continues the robust wildness of the bright Spanish culinary scene while blending in a touch of Latin American customs. The so-called Churro is more of a semantic homage to the food rather than an actual resemblance. The combination of bitter chocolate and chicken liver may sound wild and brave, but it is no more modern than what we find in traditional cuisines. Echoes of such combination resonate in the Italian "Sanguinaccio dolce," where chocolate is infused with pig's blood, or the iconic Mexican Mole sauce, both showcasing the fusion of rich, savory elements with the depth of cocoa.





As the prologue of delectable morsels draws to a close, I finally have the chance to catch my breath, allowing myself a moment to digest the preceding revelations and ready myself for the forthcoming appetizers. The first dish bore distinct traces of Japanese culinary influence, and slightly worrying was the swift return of kanpachi, which we already savored moments before. In this dish, Kanpachi sashimi is delicately rolled into the shape of a rose alongside preserved Asian pears and sliced pichuberies. Adorning the top are delicately arranged shiso blossoms, golden kiwi, myoga, and ginger zest. The entire rose is then immersed in an intoxicating and fragrant pichuberry ponzu and ginger oil. With just one bite, my concern about the swift resurgence of kanpachi is quickly dispelled by the extraordinary flavor profile of this dish. It showcases brilliance with vibrant hues, boasting a delicate balance of bright acidity and vivid fruity tastes, all thanks to the magical fusion of traditional Japanese sashimi with an array of fruits. The magic component here is the pichuberry, which carries a mesmerizing tropical flavor that is both deeply sweet like a fully ripened grape, and tartly earthy like a sweet cherry tomato. Asian pears, ginger oil, and myoga are some of the more introverted elements here, rendering the dish a somewhat zen peacefulness and oriental roundness to counter the bright tropical hues.





Addison proclaims their cuisine as Californian cuisine, yet they never try to hide how seriously they are influenced by Japanese cuisine. In fact, these influences seem to be embraced with a certain level of pride. However, one might question whether this blend of cultures is a genuine attempt at culinary fusion or merely a fleeting trend catering to platforms like TikTok. The integration of Japanese elements into Western cuisine isn't new; it began shaping French culinary traditions in the latter half of the previous century, giving rise to the concept of fusion cuisine. Today, too many contemporary restaurants adopt this fusion idea to catch up with the somewhat dangerous trend. Some truly understand the cuisine, some only do it superficially. One phenomenon is that chawanmushi has become an inevitable dish in fusion cuisines. While sushi has long been the go-to symbol for Japanese influence, chawanmushi offers a more accessible alternative. Its core form, egg custard, holds significance across various culinary traditions, making it a versatile choice for fusion cuisine. Yet bad interpretations of chawanmushi are overly ubiquitous. I once witnessed a three-Michelin-starred French chef substituting dashi with milk, making it no different from their own egg flan, what a shame. Thus when I know there will be chawanmushi on the menu, I can't help but feel a sense of apprehension.

What I've tasted on this table, however, eventually proved that my concerns are redundant.



Addison's signature Chawanmushi dish features egg custard embedded with scallops sourced from Northern California, delicately adorned with Hokkaido Uni.

A layer of bok choy and celtuce cubes rests atop the custard, bathed in a starchy broccoli-infused broth. To complete this symphony, chive oil, and purple pickled Daikon are further adorned as the finishing touches. A traditional Japanese egg custard base made with dashi is evident, with the luxurious scallop and uni accompanying the custard, a not izakaya but rather high-end omakase restaurant style of executing chawanmushi. The wasabi that typically comes with the raw uni is substituted by the pickled daikon, and the layer of vegetables with chive oil is the ingenious and innovative enhancement to this traditional dish by chef Bradley. One could argue that the innate umami of both the scallop and uni elevates the chawanmushi into a flavor explosion, rendering the dish impeccable. However, it is the layer of vegetables that truly exemplifies oriental equilibrium flawlessly. Bok choy and celtuce are both used frequently in Chinese cuisines and has spread out to international culinary scenes, cut into small cubes, they bring a subdued yet flourishing green sensation of a botanical garden. The starchy broth is also a common way of cooking in Chinese cuisine, and has also inspired Japanese cuisine, which both cultures call it “Jade” when describing a green vegetable dish cooked with broth thickened by starch. The broccoli florets here rests in the starchy broth, just like a resplendent tableau, where stars shimmered with unparalleled brilliance.





Another pièce de résistance soon follows the step of chawanmushi, presenting us with a different approach to Japanese fusion. In a J.L. Coquet Zoulou bubble bowl rests the famous caviar dish “Egg & Rice,” a timeless composition of Regiis Ova reserve caviar, Koshihikari rice risotto, applewood-smoked sabayon, Arare puffed rice, and toasted sesame. Caviar per se is considered a type of egg, and ever since Russian times, caviar has been served traditionally with chopped hard-cooked chicken eggs. Modern interpretations never forget the heavenly marriage of the two and have thus come up with some new iconic dishes taking advantage of the two eggs, The Modern of New York City is known for its signature dish “Eggs on Eggs on Eggs.” While The Modern’s interpretation uses yolk directly, a more obscure example could be the use of sabayon, an iconic custard sauce celebrating its silky texture and luscious yolky aroma, which constitutes the famous “Oyster and Pearl” dish created by Thomas Keller. This legendary dish “Oyster and Pearl”, once named as one of the dishes that changed America, is what I believe to be the inspiration behind Addison's version. Regiis Ova caviar, a brand developed by and exclusive to chef Thomas Keller, now appears in Addison’s bowl, and the sabayon is another sharing component. Furthermore, there's a parallel drawn between the use of Koshihikari rice in Addison's dish and tapioca in Thomas Keller's creation. Although distinct, the Koshihikari rice here is finely milled to a fineness that reads both bouncy and creamy.



The use of Koshihikari, nonetheless, raises a slight concern for me. Koshihikari rice is another term that is spoiled by today's gastronomy world. It is indeed a long fancy word that most people do not know, which creates such contrast to the most mundane word "rice." Even budget-friendly casual chain restaurants like Pine & Crane are using this term to elevate their otherwise ordinary rice, lending it an air of sophistication. While Koshihikari rice is undeniably superb in quality, its frequent appearance in modern fusion menus risks diminishing its uniqueness and dignity. The use of other outstanding cultivars, such as Hitomebore and Yumepirika, thus seems urgent for our culinary world. That being said, the bouncy and creamy texture of the risotto here is still the essence of the whole dish. Combined with the explosive texture and oceanic umami of the caviar, along with the toasty Oriental aroma of the Arare rice, a multi-dimensional mouthfeel unfolds on the tongue, all harmoniously tied together by the sabayon sauce.





Maybe the previous two courses have taken us too far from Southern California to the Far East, now the chef decides to take advantage of this interlude and presents us with a traditional American fast food to bring us back to the States. The interlude comprises a bowl of ribbon-shaped malt vinegar crisps paired with a burnt onion creme fraiche with dill and burnt onion powder. On the side is a miniature housemade dill relish of a small cornichon pickled with dill and vinegar. The crisp is flavored with malt vinegar, a classic pairing for fish and chips, and the burnt onion sauce is reminiscent of ranch sauce. This dish presents a fun twist on the traditional chips and dip, yet it feels somewhat out of place amidst the refined setting on a three-Michelin-star table, particularly when the dinner atmosphere seems unprecedentedly elegant and formal. The cost of presenting fast food, even when crafted by top-tier chefs like William Bradley, is the limitation of its ceiling. Due to its overly simplistic composition and lack of flavor complexity, the dish seems linear and one-dimensional. It fails to leave a lasting impression on any level. Incidentally, those who choose to order wine pairing are offered a glass of beer with this course. While this gesture may introduce a whimsical element of casual enjoyment, it further contrasts with the sophisticated tasting menu, making the combination of chips and beer seem even more unconventional in such a formal context. What seems worse is that Addison even offers an upgrade for this course. With an additional seventy-five dollars, one gets to try this dish with caviar. I never get such ideas, not only for caviar is more than just a pricey addition to make some food more expensive, but also because chefs should be precise about what they present. This means that without any pricey additions, a dish should already be all-encompassing per the chef's design. Moreover, adding caviar to a chips and dip dish makes no difference than going to Five Guys and shaving fresh Alba white truffle on its burger.



After the surprisingly successful rendition of Chawanmushi and the ingenious use of Koshihikari rice, I am excited to witness another implementation of a somewhat less-known Japanese cooking technique in our first main dish. Excitement tinged with a hint of regret, however, that the execution of such a technique fails to impress with finesse. While most continental cuisines are hesitant to leave the skin on fish, Japanese cuisine has honed a distinctive cooking technique known as Uroko-yaki うろこ焼き or Matsukasa-yaki 松笠焼き. Such a technique not only regulates the water content in the flesh, ensuring a more concentrated umami flavor but also yields a crisp surface that provides an exquisite textural contrast. Mastering this technique, however, is exceptionally challenging, and what Addison presents fails to be a flawless example. Although Kinmedai is the fish most suitable for Matsukasa-yaki after Amadai, perhaps due to issues with controlling the oil temperature, the scales of the Kinmedai are fried until gritty and excessively oily. The beauty of Matsukasayaki lies in the clear layering and integrity of the fish scales, which should not be flaky or overly oily. What was presented in this dish resembles cheap overly-fried tempura batter debris, undoubtedly leaving us disappointed. The assortment of greens, namely scallions, fennel, artichoke, and radish, forms a standard supplement to the fish, while the clam butter sauce made with clam, oboro kombu, and chive oil, renders the dish a magical touch. The composition of the butter sauce shows tracks of Scandinavian and Japanese touches, a most popular interpretation of today's culinary world. The oboro kombu, delicate in umami and acidity, sings in perfect harmony with the clam. With the final aromatic addition of chive oil, a hypnotic butter sauce is brought to life, exploding tsunamis of creaminess saturated with depths of umami in the mouth.





Presented next is the only bread on the menu, a sourdough made with heirloom grains back in the 1700s, paired with whipped goat milk and browned butter with honey. While it has become of trend to not present a tray of bread on the side of the dining table but rather bring it out as an individual course, one has to admit that it is truly funky to see a gigantic whole

Sourdough bread on the table alongside some delicately-curated miniature dishes.

Nonetheless, the sourdough is baked with precision. A crisp crust with hints of smoky and roasted aroma showcases a glossy and caramelized finish, and when cracks open, the crispy crackling sound of the crust leads us to the inner part — rich bubbles leasing hot steam, chewy, slightly tangy, yet pleasantly aromatic with hints of caramelized nuts and vanilla.

The heirloom grains used here are grains that were grown before the introduction of intensive, scientific plant breeding, thus the grains are rich in flavor and dense in nutrients, unlike the modern over-processed wheat we've become accustomed to.

Complementing the sourdough, we have two options. The first is a whipped goat milk and the second is a browned butter with honey. The

rich complexity of the honey-kissed browned butter recalls the sophistication of aged Sauternes wine, adding depth to the ensemble. Its caramelized sweetness harmonizes beautifully with the toasty aroma of the bread, creating a delightful fusion of flavors. Meanwhile, the whipped goat milk stands out for its pure, pristine dairy essence, accentuated by a bold hint of goat's smell that might be too intense for certain palates but a heavenly kiss for those who enjoy it.





Amidst the climax of our degustation journey celebrating the fusion of French cuisine techniques and Japanese cuisine inspirations, a wind from Thailand suddenly breezes in, bringing surprises of confusion. Following the sourdough, the subsequent course unveils a Thai soup known as Tom Kha Gai-Goong. In Thai, "Gai" signifies chicken, while "Goong" refers to shrimp. This dish is a rendition of the renowned Thai soup, Tom Kha Goong. Crafted with a base of Swarnadwipa curry mix and shrimp stock, this soup takes a distinctive turn by featuring King crab instead of shrimp. Within, beech mushrooms and finger lime infuse rich earthy umami and vibrant citrusy acidity, providing a delightful burst of flavors. The precious finger lime further bestows the soup with a popping mouthfeel, adding a contrast to the foamy frothy soup. Accompanying the soup is a serving of crispy sweet and sour chicken nuggets, lending the dish its title Gai-Goong. Regrettably, the superb flavor of the soup couldn't mask the profound mediocrity of the chicken nuggets. They are dry and lacking in flavor, falling short of even Panda Express's orange chicken. Pairing sweet and sour chicken with Tom Kha soup appears unnecessary, resulting in a disjointed flavor experience akin to having two unrelated actors on stage. Back to the overall course, inserting a Thai soup between two main courses once more appears superfluous. Despite the soup's exceptional quality, its relevance to the menu must be questioned.





The final savory course ultimately lands on the table, concluding the savory part of the degustation journey with yet another opus amalgamating the French and Japanese culinary cultures. Themed around squab, this dish showcases various parts of the bird, each treated with distinct cooking techniques carefully selected by the chefs for optimal flavor. The breast and tenderloin undergo grilling for a robust char, while the leg is meticulously cooked over a six-hour confit process for exquisite tenderness. Completing the ensemble is a Yakitori-style heart, adding an additional layer of smoky tone to the medley. The squab ensemble is supplemented by an assortment of vegetables comprising pickled cucumber, pickled purple daikon, and Cipollini onion, all of which are common meat-course accompaniments found in both Japanese and French cuisine. A quenelle of peanut butter miso hides in between the meat, unveiling a modern interpretation of Japan's celebrated miso sauce, while the soubise onion purée counters the miso with a traditional touch of French flavor. To finish the whole, a sauce of sweet and savory shoyu marks a circle on the plate, encapsulating and unifying the flavors with its simple yet versatile umami.



Each component of this dish indeed showcases the creativity and culinary mastery of the chef, yet presenting a myriad of overly complex flavors without a coherent logical connection seems less than ideal. The multitude of cooking methods applied to the bird results in a lack of a clear focal point in taste. Excessive spice on the legs distracts from appreciating the confit leg's delicate texture and diminishes the bird's natural flavor and depth. Regarding the sauces, while the fusion of peanut butter and miso is innovative and exciting, it appears disconnected from the other accompaniments, and the synergy between shoyu and soubise onion puree is unmercifully raped by the heaviness of the peanut butter. Another disappointment is how this dish reinforces the redundancy of the preceding Thai-inspired soup. Coming off the impact of the Tom Kha, one's palate is overwhelmed by intense Thai flavors and spiciness, detracting from fully appreciating the complexity of the squab dish.





The stacking of two rich-flavored courses evokes our desire for a palate cleanser, and here comes the yuzu and mint blancmange, arriving just on time to relieve the burden on our palate. The simple creation consists of a blancmange base with yuzu and mint flavor, a thin layer of matcha in the form of a traditional Japanese manner, then the espuma of matcha. While uncertain if it qualifies as a blancmange, the base's delicate and light texture leans more towards a blancmange than a panna cotta. Flavor-wise, its refreshing nature is multifaceted, offering a clean blend of citrus and herbal notes that gently linger on the palate, evoking a zephyr of lightness. The matcha cleverly avoids dominating the flavor, setting itself in the back, saturating the blancmange with a zen filter that highlights the Oriental beauteousness. Its espuma, with its airy lightness, further complements the dish with a gentle touch.

Unlike most fine dining restaurants that presents the main dessert followed by an array of petit fours, Addison choose to put everything on the table at once, which arouses confusions as if they are rushing us to finish the meal hastily. That being said, the center of such assortment is still conspicuous. Although the restaurant has successfully presented the fusion of French and Japanese cuisines, its American heritage remains unconcealed. Unsurprisingly, their main dessert is a reimagined version of an American classic: a tribute to s'mores composed of a thin artistic layer of chocolate tuile, a delicate layered hazelnut cacao cake that is somewhat introverted with an accent on its bitterness, a hidden toasted marshmallow, and a passionfruit mezcal caramel sauce to finish the whole with a contrast of bright tropical fruitiness and dark depth of sweetness. The straightforward classic now dons the guise of a French patisserie, metamorphosing into a refined and indulgent creation.





The assortment of petit fours unveils a spectrum of contrasting flavor profiles and pastry techniques. Though small in size, sampling each bite one after another resembles a journey around the globe. The miniature expedition begins with a berry-beet tartelette. Its delicate shell, crafted from berries and beets, offers a crisp texture and delightful sweetness. Nestled within is a hemisphere of vanilla cream, beet and berry compote, along with a verjus filling. Incorporating beet into a dessert presents a challenge, yet its naturally concentrated sweetness and subtle floral notes harmonize beautifully with the tartness and sweetness of the berries. The verjus, with its mildly sweet wine flavor, complemented by a sharp edge and faintly tart finish, adds further balance to the ensemble. Next, a classic French bonbon takes the stage. Encased in a traditional white chocolate and toasted macaroon almond coating lies a heart of caramelized honey, imparting a luscious creamy sweetness with depth. Rosemary and ginger are further introduced, lending their refreshing herbal aroma and subtly spicy notes to counter the richness of the bonbon. Our culinary journey then takes us from France to England and India, where we are welcomed by a carrot cake cone filled with orange marmalade. Adorned with a nutmeg cream cheese frosting and candied orange, the cone also hints at prominent cardamom flavors, reminiscent of kulfi ice cream for exotic sensations. Lastly, Addison's own rendition of tres leches awaits, transporting us to the other side of the globe in a taco-shaped feuille. This miniature adaptation of the Latin American signature dessert features a compacted cream filling of evaporated milk, condensed milk, and whole milk. Replacing the traditional sponge cake with crispy thin feuilles introduces a delightful contrast in texture, distinguishing it from the original version. The sumptuous and exquisite dinner draws to a close as the servers guide us through a brief tour of the kitchen before escorting us to the door, presenting us with a final farewell gift, a bag of toffee candy adorned with sunflower seeds. Filled with contentment and joy, we depart.







